CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

VIDEO EDITOR IN THE AI ERA

Every brand is a media company now, and the editor is the person who makes the content actually watchable.

★ **TL;DR — Median around $75K, fully remote, no credentials, learnable in 1–6 months. The catch: basic cutting is being automated — pacing, story and platform instinct are the paid skills.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

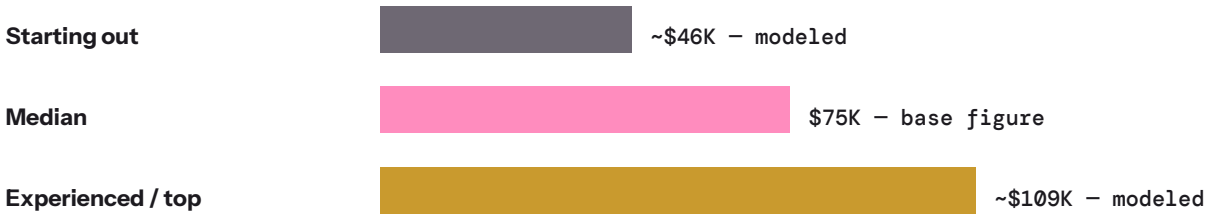
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- Demand follows the creator economy: brands, agencies and creators all hire editors, often freelance first.
- The reel is the resume — nobody reads a cover letter in this field.
- AI cuts the rough assembly; the human decides what a viewer feels at second 12.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Video Editor is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A VIDEO EDITOR ACTUALLY DO?

✓ Cut raw footage into finished videos: pacing, story, rhythm

✓ Add captions, music, sound design and simple motion graphics

✓ Repurpose one shoot into many formats — long, short, vertical

✓ Manage revisions, exports and deadlines for clients or a team

Think: the drummer of content — invisible when perfect, and the whole thing falls apart when the timing is off.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI does transcription, captions, rough cuts, silence removal and format conversions. The mechanical first pass is fully automatable now.	Story judgment: which take, which pause, which joke survives. Platform taste — knowing what this audience watches to the end — stays human.

⚠ **The bottom of this market (cheap clip-chopping) is crowded and shrinking. Editors who think like storytellers and marketers charge the rates worth having.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Portfolio-based hiring — no gatekeepers ✓ Freelance, agency or in-house, your choice ✓ Your work is public and shareable	✗ Deadline crunches are the default setting ✗ Revision notes like 'make it pop' with no further detail ✗ Export-render-wait is a real slice of your life

Good fit? You watch videos analytically, feel pacing in your bones, and can take brutal feedback on creative work without melting.
Bad fit? You need your creative choices respected — clients will request the worse version, and they'll be right about their audience sometimes.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — CREATOR ECONOMY FREELANCE	DOOR B — AGENCY / BRAND JUNIOR
Master one editor (Premiere Pro or DaVinci Resolve), cut spec work for creators you admire, and pitch them your versions. Small creators hire fast and pay per video.	Join an agency or brand content team as a junior editor. Slower creative freedom, steady paycheck, and a reel built on real campaigns within a year.

Smart move: Post editing breakdowns: take a viral video and show, cut by cut, why it retains viewers. Creators hire editors who demonstrably understand retention.

Where you land after: Senior editor → creative lead / post-production supervisor, or a creator-economy studio of your own.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
ONE EDITOR,	THE INVISIBLE	SPEC PORTFOLIO	FIRST PAYING	SPEED AND	SPECIALIZE UP-MARKET

STEP 1 — One editor, deeply

FREE–$25/MO · WEEKS 1–3

- Premiere Pro or DaVinci Resolve (free) — shortcuts, workflow, exports.
- Edit something every day; volume builds taste faster than courses.

STEP 2 — The invisible skills

FREE · WEEKS 3–6

- Audio cleanup, captions, color basics, pacing for retention.
- Study the first 3 seconds of videos that hook you — that's the job.

STEP 3 — Spec portfolio

FREE · MONTHS 1–2

- Re-edit 3 published videos into better versions; keep before/afters.
- One long-form, one short-form, one ad — show range with intent.

STEP 4 — First paying clients

MONTHS 2–4

- Pitch creators and local brands with a free sample cut of THEIR footage.
- Price per video or per package; track revision rounds in the deal.

STEP 5 — Speed and systems

MONTHS 3–5

- Templates, presets, organized project files — speed is margin.
- Add motion graphics basics to raise your rate ceiling.

STEP 6 — Specialize up-market

MONTHS 4–6

- Pick a niche: podcasts, ads, real estate, faceless channels — one where you know the grammar cold.
- Raise rates per niche proof; generalists compete with software.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: install your editor and cut a 60-second video from any footage you own.

□ Days 1–30: daily editing reps; captions, audio and pacing fundamentals working.

□ Days 31–60: spec portfolio of 3 pieces finished; first pitches sent with sample cuts.

□ Days 61–90: first paying client(s) delivered; templates and workflow system in place.

□ Day 90: a reel that proves taste, clients who prove demand, and a niche chosen.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ THE CUT IS THE CONTENT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.